

The Good, Bad and Ugly Faces of AI

It is imperative for technologists and users to be aware of both the positive and negative impacts of a technology to mitigate the risks that accompany every advancement.

The effect of AI is more far-reaching than any technology we have seen in recent times—every development in AI seems to come with varying degrees of social, political, economic, and environmental impact. On the positive side, we see AI helping with health care, agricultural management, education in remote regions, access to knowledge in the vernacular, drug discovery, weather modelling, increased efficiency in organisations, and much more. On the negative side, AI is being used to scam and dupe people, spread misinformation, hack into systems, monitor people illegally, and so on. We also see job roles vanishing, companies downsizing.

As Spider Man's Uncle Ben keeps reminding him, "With great power comes great responsibility!" AI has the power to improve this world in unprecedented ways, but only if the makers and users of AI technologies and tools remain constantly aware of the potential risks and fix the loopholes before they can be misused. To keep reminding ourselves and our readers of this fine balance, we shall now pause for a moment, look around, and spot something good, bad,

and ugly about AI, an exercise that we like to do every once in a while.

Good: Lots of it could be seen at the India AI Impact Summit

AI's potential to improve people's lives was clearly palpable at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi in February 2026. More notably, the event showcased AI's ability to inclusively help everyone, not just urban, tech-savvy folks, quickly chalking up points in favour of AI!

In India, one of the main challenges to inclusivity is the country's language diversity. If AI were available only in English, it would never reach those who need it most. With solutions to this, Sarvam AI turned out to be a breakout star at the summit, impressing a great number of the attendees, including our Prime Minister!

Sarvam AI announced and open sourced two large language models—Sarvam 30B (30 billion parameters) and Sarvam 105B (105 billion parameters, using a mixture-of-experts architecture). Both models have been trained on in-house datasets and support advanced reasoning, multilingual tasks,

mathematics, and coding. The 30B model is optimised for efficiency and can power conversational AI across Indian languages, even running on low-end devices such as feature phones.

They showcased an interesting product stack, with Sarvam Dub, which can dub content into other Indian languages in the user's original voice; Sarvam Vision, a multimodal model that can extract text, tables, charts, and structured data from multi-lingual documents and images; and Sarvam Edge, which runs speech and translation models locally on edge devices without internet connectivity. And then, of course, Sarvam Kaze, the smart glasses that seemed to have caught our Prime Minister's eye! This AI-powered wearable glass, likely to be commercially launched in May 2026, can listen, understand, and capture what users see in real time, with support for voice-based interaction and real-time translation into more than 10 Indian languages.

Sarvam will be working with the governments of Odisha and Tamil Nadu to build sovereign AI infrastructure, and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) plans to use Sarvam's multi-lingual AI tools to improve the reach of their investor awareness programme.

Apart from Sarvam, BharatGen, Gnani.ai, Tech Mahindra, and Fractal also unveiled new sovereign AI models, which is a big step towards AI independence for India.

Small AI for big impact. The 'Small AI for Big Impact' session at the summit showcased several affordable, lightweight AI solutions that can run on everyday devices with limited connectivity. There were many



Government-backed Bharat-VISTAAR is a multilingual, AI-enabled farming advisory (Courtesy: Skymet)